

WEEK 2 OF 4 · Breath

Script 2: Belly Breathing (Diaphragmatic Breathing)**Theme: Energy and Grounding**

Rationale: Modern humans often breathe with their chests. This exercise teaches students to breathe from the abdomen — the "energy core" — to access a deeper, more grounding breath.

Request that students find their meditation stance. Remind students of the "out."

"Today we are going to learn how to breathe from our abdomen, our 'energy core.' Let's begin by settling into our stance. Notice your base sinking into the floor. Feel your body aligned with the ground and its connection to the ground. You can close your eyes if you feel comfortable or lower your gaze towards the ground.

I invite you to place one hand on your stomach. We are going to notice the gentle rise and fall of your stomach with every breath. Inhale slowly through your nose and feel your hand rise. (Pause for 3 seconds.) Almost like you are filling a balloon. Now exhale slowly through your nose and let your hand fall along with your stomach as you empty the air from the balloon. Practice this for a few moments. Feel the air filling the bottom of your lungs. (Pause for 20 seconds.)

As you breathe, try to make your exhale slightly longer than your inhale. This signals your body to relax and focus. Keep practicing. If you notice your mind jumping around, that's okay. Gently bring your mind back to the feeling of your hand rising and falling. (Pause for 20 seconds.)

When you are ready, lower your hand, open your eyes, and come back to the room."